Workforce Practices Tips and Tricks

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Strong workforce practices help you find the right people, get them started well, and keep them. Most of these cost little or nothing.

Hire well

- **Write a clear job description.** Duties, schedule, pay range, and qualifications.
- **Ask the same questions.** Use consistent interview questions so it's fair to compare.
- **Show the real job.** A short paid working interview or observation helps both sides decide.
- **Check references.** And complete all required background checks.

Onboard on purpose

- **Use a checklist.** Paperwork, policies, routines, and emergency procedures.
- **Plan the first week.** Shadowing time before working alone.
- **Name a go-to person.** Someone new staff can ask questions.
- **Check in at 30 days.** Ask what's going well and what's confusing.

Support and recognize

- **Hold regular one-on-ones.** Even 15 minutes a month helps.
- **Give quick feedback.** Specific praise and early, kind correction.
- **Recognize good work.** Thank-you notes, shout-outs, and celebrations.
- **Hold short staff meetings.** Share updates and ask for ideas.

Support growth

- **Pay for training time.** It shows you value learning.
- **Celebrate credentials.** Link new credentials to pay steps when you can.
- **Set goals together.** Ask staff what they'd like to learn next.

For home-based providers

- **Grow yourself too.** Set your own professional development goal for the year.
- **Prepare substitutes.** A short guide to your routine makes coverage easier.
- **Connect with peers.** Peer Connections is a support network; use it.

Questions? Contact your Business Specialist: [name, email, phone]